

Last Light

48-Hour Production Plan

Product: Mobile-first portrait auto-runner / avoidance game

Core theme: At the end of each stage, choose between permanent sacrifice for safety or greater risk.

Target: Six short stages, 3-5 minute run, one-finger controls, replayability through different decisions.

PM Operating Rules

- No feature is added unless another feature is removed.
- Gameplay before polish. Anything outside the critical path waits.
- Every task must have dependencies, acceptance criteria, and a test.
- A completed task is not Done until it is tested.
- Feature freeze begins at Hour 38.
- Ship stable over ambitious.

Protected Product Pillars

- Portrait, one-finger horizontal drag controls
- Auto-runner structure
- Health and relic light as separate resources
- Permanent sacrifices that affect later stages
- Six fixed short stages
- 3-5 minute complete run
- Multiple outcomes and replay value through decisions

Milestone Gates

Gate	Target	Pass condition	PM rule
G1 - Core playable	Hour 8	Character moves, takes damage, dies and restarts.	Proceed only when restart is stable.
G2 - Theme playable	Hour 16	Two decisions exist and one permanent cost is felt in the next stage.	Vertical slice must validate the theme.
G3 - End-to-end	Hour 28	Six stages complete from opening to ending.	Cut optional systems if this gate slips.
G4 - Mobile usable	Hour 32	Input, safe area and performance pass on a real device.	Blocking mobile gate.
G5 - Content complete	Hour 38	Two obstacles, four costs/risks, two endings and essential UI are complete.	Start feature freeze after this gate.
G6 - Submission ready	Hour 48	No blockers; build, description, screenshots and controls are ready.	Ship stable over ambitious.

48-Hour Schedule

Hours	Goal	Tasks	Allowed work	Cut trigger
0-8	Core playable	LL-001 to LL-007	Control, survival, two obstacles	No polish before restart is stable
8-16	Theme vertical slice	LL-008 to LL-012	Stage flow, choice, first costs, light	Use placeholder UI and art
16-28	End-to-end run	LL-013 to LL-017	Six stages, ending, essential UX	Cut third obstacle and variation
28-38	Mobile, content and playable	LL-018 to LL-022	Device fixes, fairness, minimum art/audio	Cut music layers and extra endings
38-48	Feature freeze	LL-023 to LL-024	Blocker, build and readability fixes only	No new systems

Implementation Backlog

Tasks are ordered by the planned critical path. Status should be maintained in the shared Google Sheet.

LL-001 - Create portrait project baseline and Pixel Perfect camera

Epic: E1 Core Controller **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: None

Acceptance: Scene runs at 9:16 reference resolution with correct camera framing and no Console errors.

Implementation note: Critical path

LL-002 - Implement touch and mouse horizontal drag movement

Epic: E1 Core Controller **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-001

Acceptance: A first-time player can move left and right within 10 seconds using mouse or one finger.

Implementation note: No inertia or joystick

LL-003 - Implement health, damage and invulnerability

Epic: E2 Survival Loop **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-002

Acceptance: Obstacle contact removes one health and repeated contact is blocked for 0.8-1.0 seconds.

Implementation note: Start health 3

LL-004 - Implement death and fast restart

Epic: E2 Survival Loop **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-003

Acceptance: At zero health the run ends and a new run begins within five seconds with all state reset.

Implementation note: Protected core

LL-005 - Build reusable obstacle base and collision setup

Epic: E3 Obstacle Framework **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-003

Acceptance: Obstacle prefabs damage the player once per valid contact and reset correctly.

Implementation note: Critical path

LL-006 - Create spike wall prefab and variations

Epic: E3 Obstacle Framework **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-005

Acceptance: Spike wall has a clearly readable safe corridor and configurable gap position and width.

Implementation note: MVP obstacle 1

LL-007 - Create moving blade prefab

Epic: E3 Obstacle Framework **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G1

Dependencies: LL-005

Acceptance: Blade moves horizontally with configurable speed and phase and remains visually readable.

Implementation note: MVP obstacle 2

LL-008 - Implement stage start, completion and sequence flow

Epic: E4 Level Flow **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2 h **Gate:** G2

Dependencies: LL-004, LL-006

Acceptance: A stage starts, progresses automatically, completes once, and transitions without soft lock.

Implementation note: Critical path

LL-009 - Create CostData ScriptableObject

Epic: E5 Choice & Cost **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G2

Dependencies: LL-008

Acceptance: An offer stores icon, short copy, benefit, cost or risk type, and value without scene-specific logic.

Implementation note: Stable public API

LL-010 - Implement physical two-offer ChoiceGate

Epic: E5 Choice & Cost **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2 h **Gate:** G2

Dependencies: LL-008, LL-009

Acceptance: Dragging into an altar selects exactly one offer, applies it once, and advances the flow.

Implementation note: No confirmation button

LL-011 - Implement CostApplier and modifier caps

Epic: E5 Choice & Cost **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2.5 h **Gate:** G2

Dependencies: LL-009, LL-010

Acceptance: At least one permanent cost visibly affects the next stage and all modifiers respect documented limits.

Implementation note: Blood, Light, Sight, Body

LL-012 - Implement relic light resource

Epic: E6 Relic & Endings **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G2

Dependencies: LL-011

Acceptance: Light starts at 100%, updates through events, may reach 0%, and resets on restart.

Implementation note: Separate from health

LL-013 - Implement ending resolver and outcome screen

Epic: E6 Relic & Endings **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 2 h **Gate:** G3

Dependencies: LL-012

Acceptance: At least two endings trigger correctly from remaining-light thresholds and show Retry.

Implementation note: Target 3, minimum 2

LL-014 - Assemble six fixed stage chunks

Epic: E4 Level Flow **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 4 h **Gate:** G3

Dependencies: LL-007, LL-008, LL-011

Acceptance: The game completes from opening through six stages to an ending in under five minutes.

Implementation note: Use placeholders first

LL-015 - Create start screen and micro-tutorial

Epic: E7 UX/UI **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G3

Dependencies: LL-002

Acceptance: Tap starts the run and the drag hint disappears after first movement.

Implementation note: Short English copy

LL-016 - Create HUD for health, stage and light

Epic: E7 UX/UI **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G3

Dependencies: LL-003, LL-012

Acceptance: HUD reflects health, current stage and light without containing game logic.

Implementation note: Safe area required

LL-017 - Create concise decision cards

Epic: E7 UX/UI **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G3

Dependencies: LL-009, LL-010

Acceptance: Each card shows an icon, one benefit line, and Cost or Risk copy within roughly 8-12 words.

Implementation note: Readability gate

LL-018 - Run first real-device input test

Epic: E9 QA & Submission **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1 h **Gate:** G4

Dependencies: LL-002, LL-004

Acceptance: Input, safe area and frame rate are acceptable on at least one Android device.

Implementation note: Mandatory early test

LL-019 - Pass min-speed and max-body fairness matrix

Epic: E9 QA & Submission **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G5

Dependencies: LL-011, LL-014

Acceptance: Every stage is passable at minimum allowed movement speed and maximum character size.

Implementation note: Block release if failed

LL-020 - Replace critical placeholders with minimum pixel-art set

Epic: E8 Art/Audio Polish **Priority:** Should **Estimate:** 4 h **Gate:** G5

Dependencies: G3 passed

Acceptance: Traveller, light, two obstacles, altar and minimum ending visuals are readable and integrated.

Implementation note: Must not block critical path

LL-021 - Add essential SFX and impact feedback

Epic: E8 Art/Audio Polish **Priority:** Should **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G5

Dependencies: G3 passed

Acceptance: Damage, cost selection and stage transition have clear feedback; shadow remains readable muted.

Implementation note: Music optional

LL-022 - Run external playtest and decision review

Epic: E9 QA & Submission **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 1.5 h **Gate:** G5

Dependencies: G3 passed

Acceptance: Record control comprehension, cost clarity, fairness, run time and retry intent; convert findings into prioritized fixes.

Implementation note: 5-10 rapid tests

LL-023 - Feature freeze and blocker-only pass

Epic: E9 QA & Submission **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 4 h **Gate:** G6

Dependencies: G5 passed

Acceptance: Only blocker, build and readability fixes are accepted; zero blocker bugs remain.

Implementation note: Begins with 10 hours remaining

LL-024 - Create final build and submission assets

Epic: E9 QA & Submission **Priority:** Must **Estimate:** 3 h **Gate:** G6

Dependencies: LL-023

Acceptance: Final build, controls, description, screenshots and submission page are complete and smoke-tested.

Implementation note: Primary Android unless rules require WebGL

Decisions and Risks

Locked Decisions

Scope rule [Accepted] - No feature is added unless another feature is removed.

Primary build [Pending] - Android by default; switch to WebGL only if jam rules require it.

Language [Accepted] - Use icon-heavy short English copy.

Ending count [Pending] - Three target, two minimum; decide after G3.

Core loop [Locked] - Auto-run, horizontal one-finger movement, damage avoidance, end-stage choice, permanent sacrifice.

Resources [Locked] - Health and relic light are separate resources.

Run structure [Locked] - Six short fixed stages, total run length 3-5 minutes.

Feature freeze [Locked] - Begins at Hour 38. Only blocker, build and readability fixes after that point.

Active Risks

R-01: Scope growth - Likelihood High; Impact High. Response: Move new ideas to Parking Lot unless they replace existing scope.

R-02: Mobile input feel - Likelihood Medium; Impact High. Response: Run early real-device test and tune smoothing.

R-03: Impossible cost combinations - Likelihood Medium; Impact High. Response: Cap modifiers and test minimum speed with maximum body size.

Claude Code Usage

Place this package in the project root. Instruct Claude Code to read DECISIONS.md first, then ROADMAP.md, then TASKS.md. It should work only on the first unchecked task whose dependencies are complete, avoid out-of-scope features, and report changed files plus test results after each task.